



Republic of the Philippines
DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION

DEPARTMENT ORDER 2022- 024

Subject : GUIDELINES ON FOREIGN AND OFFICIAL LOCAL TRAVELS, STREAMLINING PROCEDURES FOR THE ISSUANCE OF AUTHORITY THEREFOR, AND STANDARDIZING TRAVEL DOCUMENTS IN THE DEPARTMENT

Date : 17 November 2022

1.0 PURPOSE

This Order is issued in order to streamline the processing of all requests for travel authority, standardize travel documents, and facilitate transactions pursuant to Executive Order (EO) 77, s. 2019¹ dated 15 March 2019 and other related issuances.

This Order further aims to clarify existing rules and practices and avoid delays in the issuance of travel orders, owing to incomplete supporting documents and inadequate lead time for processing.

2.0 COVERAGE

This Order shall cover the following:

- 2.1. Official and non-official foreign travels and official local travels, as herein defined, made by officials and personnel of the Department; and
- 2.2. Official and non-official foreign travels made by heads of sectoral or attached agencies and corporations;

3.0 DEFINITION OF TERMS

For purposes of this Order, the following terms shall mean:

- 3.1. **Permanent Official Station** - The regular place of work of an official or employee, where he/she is expected to stay most of the time as

¹ Prescribing Rules and Regulations and Rates of Expenses and Allowances for Official Local and Foreign Travels of Government Personnel

required by the nature, duties, and responsibilities of his/her position. The term shall include a satellite office of the Department where such official or employee is permitted to work, pursuant to existing and future issuances on flexiplace in the Department.

- 3.2. **Local Travel** - Travel beyond a 50-kilometer radius from the permanent official station, for official purposes such as training, meeting, inspection, investigation, audit, and procurement post-qualification.
- 3.3. **Foreign Travel** - Travel outside of the Philippines, which may either be official or not.
- 3.4. **International Commitment** - A bilateral or multilateral undertaking of the Philippine Government or the Department with a foreign governmental entity or intergovernmental organization (*e.g.*, the United Nations, Association of Southeast Asian Nations, and Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation), falling under the monitoring functions of the International Cooperation Division (ICD).
- 3.5. **Travel Order (TO)** - A document authorizing foreign or official local travels, issued to officials and employees of the Department and its sectoral or attached agencies and corporations, with corresponding travel entitlements, if applicable.
- 3.6. **Recommending or Approving Authority** - The officials designated as such in existing or future issuances on delegation and delineation of functions and authority in the Department.

4.0 **GUIDELINES ON FOREIGN TRAVELS**

- 4.1. Foreign TOs (FTO) shall be required for officials and employees attending or participating in the following official undertakings:
 - 4.1.1. International conferences, conventions and meetings in which the Department takes part pursuant to an international commitment;
 - 4.1.2. Trainings, scholarships, fellowships, and other study programs;
 - 4.1.3. Speaking engagements or receiving of awards from foreign governments/institutions or international organizations; and
 - 4.1.4. Other travels for official purposes such as factory acceptance tests and product inspection.

- 4.2. FTOs shall likewise be required for covered officials and employees traveling in a non-official capacity, even if made at their own personal expense.
- 4.3. The travel requests must be endorsed by the requesting individual's immediate supervisor, who shall hold or be designated to a Director III position or higher. For heads of sectoral or attached agencies and corporations, the endorsement of its Human Resources Development Division or equivalent office is sufficient.
- 4.4. Only those who have permanent appointments may travel abroad to take part in international conferences, conventions and meetings, unless otherwise authorized by the Secretary.
- 4.5. Requests for FTOs, in the prescribed form and with all necessary supporting documents, shall be submitted to the Human Resource Development Division (HRDD) at least ten (10) working days prior to departure, except under exceptional circumstances duly explained in the request.
- 4.6. In case of international commitments, all requests for FTOs from members of the same delegation, and their supporting staff, if any, shall be processed as a whole, to be initially submitted to ICD, together with all supporting documents, for collation. In this instance, ICD shall act as the requesting office for the entire delegation, and ensure that all requisite documents are timely forwarded to HRDD.

Only one (1) FTO shall be issued to the entire delegation and their support staff, if any.
- 4.7. Submission of subsequent piecemeal requests—made after the original application and beyond the period provided in item 5.0 hereof—such as those for additional entitlements or trips and the inclusion of new members of the delegation or supporting staff, shall be avoided.
- 4.8. In case of trips involving delegations, the number of participants is kept to the barest minimum and the role of each member in the delegation is clearly specified and justified in the travel request.
- 4.9. The Department or agency concerned may defray only pre-departure expenses relative to scholarships, fellowships, trainings, and studies abroad, unless a written agreement with the grantor or donor provides otherwise.
- 4.10. Agencies concerned and, in the case of international commitments, the ICD, shall ensure that all reportorial requirements (e.g., post-travel reports) arising from previous travels had been complied with by anyone seeking an FTO.

- 4.11. No authority for a government-sponsored foreign travel may be issued to anyone failing to liquidate or account for expenses arising from a previous similarly sponsored foreign travel.
- 4.12. Within thirty (30) calendar days from returning to the permanent official station, the official or employee authorized to travel shall submit to the Office of the Secretary, thru the Undersecretary concerned, copy-furnished HRDD, a post-travel report containing, among others, the benefits derived from and his/her recommendations on the meeting, conference, or seminar attended, or the results of the inspection, investigation, or mission undertaken.
- 4.13. In case of participation in an international conference or convention in which the Philippines is represented by a delegation, the post-travel report of the delegation shall be submitted to the OP through the Department Secretary, copy furnished the Secretary of the Department of Foreign Affairs, not later than thirty (30) calendar days after the closing of the conference or convention. Any member of the delegation may also submit a supplementary report.

5.0 GUIDELINES ON LOCAL TRAVEL

- 5.1. The travel requests must be endorsed by the requesting individual's immediate supervisor, who shall hold or be designated to a Director III position or higher.
- 5.2. Covered officials and employees traveling officially beyond a 50-kilometer radius from their permanent station shall secure a local TO (LTO) from the designated approving authority unless the destination is located within a 50-kilometer radius from their actual or usual place of residence or within a similar radius from a satellite office where they are permitted to work, in which case only an Official Business slip may be obtained or OB request may be filed electronically via the DOTr Human Resource Information System (HRIS).
- 5.3. Officials and employees of the DOTr Central Office issued with an LTO may secure a cash advance or claim reimbursement for travel expenses incurred, in an amount not exceeding that which is authorized by EO 77, s. 2019 or other relevant issuances, subject, in any case, to the approval of the designated approving authority and the availability of funds.
- 5.4. Those receiving transportation allowance or assigned a service vehicle shall not be allowed to claim cash advance or reimbursement for transportation expenses unless the travel is made by air or sea.

- 5.5. Requests for LTOs, in the prescribed form and with all necessary supporting documents, shall be submitted to the approving authority at least seven (7) working days for training-related LTOs and (5) working days for others, prior to departure, except under exceptional circumstances, in which case the request may be submitted at least five (5) and three (3) working days, respectively, prior to departure.
- 5.6. Within thirty (30) calendar days from returning to the permanent official station, the official or employee authorized to travel shall submit to HRDD a *Certificate of Attendance/Appearance* and, whenever applicable, a post-training or -travel report.

6.0 PROVISIONS COMMON TO BOTH FOREIGN AND LOCAL TRAVELS

- 6.1. No travel covered by this Order may be funded in full or in part, whether directly or indirectly, by private individuals, suppliers, or contractors who have pending requests, applications, transactions, and contracts or who otherwise have commercial dealings with the Department and its sectoral or attached agencies and corporations. Only those with specific contractual obligations are allowed.
- 6.2. Requests for official or non-official travel by Division Chiefs and up shall include a nomination of an Officer-in-Charge to ensure the unhampered operations of his/her office.
- 6.3. The grant, utilization, and liquidation of cash advances or claims for reimbursement of expenses on account of official foreign and local travels shall comply with the pertinent provisions of EO No. 77, s. 2019, Commission on Audit Circular 2012-001,² and other relevant issuances, ad subject to availability of funds and applicable budgeting, accounting, and auditing rules and regulations.
- 6.4. Workers engaged under Job Orders, Contract of Service, and the like may travel locally, as may be necessary in the performance of their tasks and provided in their service contracts, but in no case may they travel abroad in an official capacity. They shall likewise secure an LTO for the purpose and may secure cash advance or claim reimbursement for expenses incurred in the course thereof, subject to prior approvals, availability of funds, and applicable budgeting, accounting and auditing rules and regulations.

² Prescribing the Revised Guidelines and Documentary Requirements for Common Government Transactions, dated June 14, 2012.

- 6.5. All should directly purchase airline tickets for official travel, whether international or local, from any commercial airline at reasonable rates, as stated in item 10³, Section V, Annex H of the 2016 Revised Implementing Rules and Regulations of Republic Act No. 9184⁴. The same prudence must be exercised in all modes of transportation.
- 6.6. Travel order requests for amendment in case of changes in the dates or other details shall be filed as soon as possible while cancellation of travel order requests may be filed before or after issuance of the TO.
- 6.7. Submission of documents with electronic or digital signatures shall be accepted in accordance with Office Order No. 2022-11 dated 28 October 2022⁵ and such other relevant laws, rules and regulations for the purpose.

7.0 PROCESS FLOW AND TIMELINES

- 7.1. The following process flow shall be followed, within the timelines prescribed, for the issuance of FTOs and LTO for training-related travels:

Transaction/Activity	Office/ Individual Responsible	Processing Time
1. Submission to HRDD of the accomplished Travel Order Request Form⁶ with the following supporting documents: <u>FTOs</u> A. Common to all official FTOs • Invitation • Approved Clearance (<i>for official foreign travels with a duration of thirty (30) calendar days or more</i>) B. Specific to certain official FTOs I. International Commitments • Approved Nomination of attendees from the Department Secretary/Marginal Note of SOTr	Requesting office or individual ICD for International Commitments	N/A For original and amended requests, at least 5 working days prior to departure, for training-related LTO and any FTO, respectively. For cancellation of requests, anytime before or after issuance of FTO. Requests received beyond 4:00 p.m. are considered received the following day.

³ Direct Retail Purchase of Petroleum Fuel, Oil and Lubricant Products, and Airline Tickets, page 175 of IRR

⁴ Government Procurement Reform Act

⁵ Policy Guidelines on the Use of Electronic Signatures in the Department

⁶ The Travel Order Request Form is attached as Annex A

Transaction/Activity	Office/ Individual Responsible	Processing Time
II. Training programs, scholarships and other study trips - Scholarship or Study Contract entered into by the scholar and the Department/Attached Agency - Scholarship Offer by the sponsoring institution and Acceptance Letter by Employee/Official or equivalent documents - Memorandum of Agreement or equivalent document (<i>if government will defray costs other than pre-departure expenses</i>) III. Factory Acceptance Test/ Inspection - Contract Agreement or other documents where the Factory Acceptance Test/Inspection is authorized C. Non-official foreign travel - Approved leave application form (<i>if inclusive of working days</i>) - Approved Clearance (<i>regardless of number of days and date of travel</i>) <u>Training-related LTO</u> - Confirmation of Training Registration, or; - Training Invitation and Outline (<i>if confirmation is not yet available</i>)		
2. Initial evaluation of request 2.1 Review of the documents submitted and determination of their completeness 2.2 Preparation of memo for approving authority with the corresponding recommendation Preparation of FTO/LTO, if warranted, and forwarding thereof, together with the memo and supporting documents, to Administrative Service Director	HRDD	1 working day from receipt of complete documents, assuming no major issues are encountered.
3. Review of the memo, FTO/LTO, and supporting documents, and endorsement thereof to the recommending authority, if there is one, or the approving authority.	Administrative Service Director	1 working day

Transaction/Activity	Office/ Individual Responsible	Processing Time
4. Review of the FTO/LTO and supporting documents, and endorsement thereof to the approving authority. (If applicable)	Recommending authority (if applicable)	1 working day
5. Approval or disapproval of request, and forwarding of signed FTO/LTO or disapproved request, as the case may be, to General Service Division (GSD) Records Section	Approving authority	1 working day
6. After receipt: 6.1. For approved official FTO/LTOs, numbering, recording, proper dissemination and other appropriate action of the signed FTO/LTO. 6.2. For approved non-official FTO and disapproved official FTO/LTOs, numbering of approved FTO, transmittal to the requesting office or individual, and recording and other appropriate action.	GSD Records Section	½ working day

- 7.2. The following process flow shall be followed, within the timelines prescribed, for issuance of LTO for official local travels that are not training-related:

Transaction/Activity	Office/Individual Responsible	Processing Time
1. Submission to the recommending authority of the accomplished Travel Order Request Form, supported by the Invitation, Notice of Meeting or such other proof of necessity of the local travel.	Requesting office or the individual concerned	N/A For original and amended requests, at least 3 working days prior to departure. For cancellation of requests, anytime before or after issuance of LTO. Requests received beyond 4:00 p.m. are considered received the following day

Transaction/Activity	Office/Individual Responsible	Processing Time
2. Evaluation of request 2.1 Review of the documents submitted and determination of their completeness. 2.2 Preparation of LTO and endorsement thereof, if warranted, to the approving authority, together with the supporting documents. (If endorsement is withheld, the request shall be returned to the requesting office or individual.)	Recommending authority	1 working day from receipt of complete documents, assuming no major issues are encountered.
3. Approval or disapproval of request, and forwarding of signed LTO or disapproved request to the GSD Records Section	Approving authority	1 working day
4. After receipt: 4.1. For approved LTOs, numbering, recording, proper dissemination and other appropriate action of the signed LTO 4.2. For disapproved LTOs, transmittal to the requesting office or individual, and recording and other appropriate action.	GSD Records Section	1/2 working day

8.0 EXPENSES AND ALLOWANCES FOR OFFICIAL LOCAL AND FOREIGN TRAVELS

The rates of expenses and allowances for local and foreign travels shall be based on the provisions of EO No. 77, s. 2019 or future relevant laws, rules and regulations and subject to availability of funds and compliance with the applicable budgeting, accounting and auditing laws, rules and regulations.

9.0 RECOGNITION OF ELECTRONIC DOCUMENTS

Submission of documents for hiring, renewal and payment with electronic or digital signatures shall be accepted in accordance with Office Order No. 2022-11 dated 28 October 2022⁷ and such other relevant laws, rules and regulations for the purpose.

⁷ Policy Guidelines on the Use of Electronic Signatures in the Department

10.0 SANCTIONS

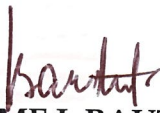
Non-compliance with the guidelines laid down herein shall be sufficient ground for the denial of the request for travel authority, without prejudice to any administrative liability, as may be warranted under the circumstances.

11.0 REPEALING CLAUSE

This Order supersedes Department Order No. 2019-009⁸ dated 28 May 2019. In addition, any other issuance inconsistent herewith shall be deemed amended, revoked or likewise superseded accordingly.

12.0 EFFECTIVITY

This Order shall take effect immediately.


JAIME J. BAUTISTA
Secretary 



⁸ Rules, Regulations, and Rates of Expenses and Allowances for Official and Foreign Travels of Government Personnel

	Republic of the Philippines		
	Department of Transportation		
	Document No: DOTr-HRDD-TO-001	Rev. No.: 2022-000	Effective Date: __ November 2022
	TRAVEL ORDER REQUEST FORM		

Note: Tick appropriate boxes ☐ and accomplish in its entirety. Indicate N/A if not applicable. Do not abbreviate.

Nature of Request	Official Local Travel	☐			
	Official Foreign Travel	☐			
	Personal Foreign Travel	☐			
	Cancel Travel Request/Order	☐		T.O. No:	(Indicate TO Number if approved or Date of Filing if pending request)
	Amend Travel Request/Order	☐		T.O. No:	

For:		(Approving Authority)
Through:		(Recommending Authority)
From:		(Requesting Office)
Filing Date:		

This is to respectfully request for travel authority for the following officials/personnel with the relevant details as follows:

Name		(Additional sheet/s may be used, for multiple travelers)
Position and Office		
Purpose	(Include the title of the program/event)	
Destination		
Supporting Documents	(list the supporting documents submitted based on the FY 2022 Foreign and Local Travel Guidelines)	
Travel Expense		
(Indicate type of expense to be shouldered by the Department/Agency)		

Details of Request	
*Relevance to the position/office in attending the event *Details to be updated with Justification (Attach a copy of the signed Travel Order, if applicable) *Reason for Cancellation (Additional sheet/s may be used, if necessary)	

Request for Designation of Officer-in-Charge	
Nominated Officer-in-Charge:	(Include name/s, position and office)
Period Covered:	

Request for Official Passport (Applicable for Foreign Travel Only)

This is to further request for an endorsement to the Department of Foreign Affairs for:

	Name & Position
Issuance of Official Passport	1 (Additional sheet/s may be used, if necessary)
Revalidation of Official Passport	1
	2
Renewal of Official Passport	1
	2

I certify that all information are true and correct to the best of my knowledge.

I acknowledge and accept the conditions that the submission of incomplete and supporting documents with discrepancies may affect the processing of the travel authority.

I agree and conform with the DOTr Data Privacy Policy.

Requested by:

Name and Signature

Office/Agency

Endorsed by:

[immediate supervisor who is at least a Dir III for DOTr-CO; the HR head or equivalent for attached agencies]

Name and Signature

Office/Agency

Evaluation and Approval

Approved ☐

Disapproved ☐

Approving Authority

(Position Title)